# Block practice · Psychological problems

Work through each question type in order. Each section has a worked-example retry and all further practice. Attempt only the part outlined in red.

Cognitive explanation of depression

Learning theory explanation of addiction

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# Practice workbook · Cognitive explanation of depression

Cognitive (e.g. Beck) explanations of depression and their strengths and weaknesses.

2 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 1 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-PRB-03

# 1. Question 12 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

**12** Maddie has been diagnosed with depression.

She has stopped going to work as she constantly feels intense sadness and cannot find the motivation to speak to anyone.

Her mum tries to encourage and reassure her, but Maddie says there is no point as she will always be a failure. Maddie says work is pointless as she claims her recent performance review was worse than she expected. She also thinks she will never get a promotion or a partner.

(a) Explain how cognitive theory could account for Maddie's depression.

**(2)**

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using cognitive theory to account for Maddie's depression.

**(4)**

Strength

Weakness

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# 1. Question 12 · part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

(c) Maddie's psychiatrist is considering whether to use drugs as a treatment for her depression. She is interested to see how a new antidepressant drug called 'H3-a' compares to a standard antidepressant.

Maddie's psychiatrist looks at clinical trial data for the new drug and compares it to the standard antidepressant in terms of relapse in symptoms and the possibility of Maddie experiencing side effects after taking the drug.

The data she is considering is shown in **Table 1**.

| | New antidepressant 'H3-a' | Standard antidepressant |
|---|---|---|
| **Average percentage (%) of patients reporting relapse in symptoms after 1 year** | 22 | 35 |
| **Average percentage (%) of patients reporting severe side effects** | 25 | 15 |

**Table 1**

Explain **one** conclusion that Maddie's psychiatrist could make regarding the new antidepressant drug 'H3-a' compared to the standard antidepressant using **Table 1**.

**(2)**

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## 1. Question 12 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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## 2. Question 12 · part a · 2 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

**12** Maddie has been diagnosed with depression.

She has stopped going to work as she constantly feels intense sadness and cannot find the motivation to speak to anyone.

Her mum tries to encourage and reassure her, but Maddie says there is no point as she will always be a failure. Maddie says work is pointless as she claims her recent performance review was worse than she expected. She also thinks she will never get a promotion or a partner.

(a) Explain how cognitive theory could account for Maddie's depression.

**(2)**

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using cognitive theory to account for Maddie's depression.

**(4)**

Strength

Weakness

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## 2. Question 12 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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# Practice workbook · Learning theory explanation of addiction

Learning theory (conditioning and social learning) as an explanation of addiction, with strengths and weaknesses.

2 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 1 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-PRB-04

# 1. Question 12 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

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**12** Jeremie used to watch his father on online auction sites. Jeremie was interested in the bidding and how much pleasure 'winning' an item gave his father.

Jeremie joined the online auction sites when he became old enough to buy the items himself. He has been buying hundreds of items from the auctions and has recently been diagnosed with an internet addiction to online auction sites.

(a) Explain how **one** symptom of addiction will affect Jeremie.

**(2)**

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# 1. Question 12 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using learning theory to account for Jeremie's addiction.

**(4)**

Strength

Weakness

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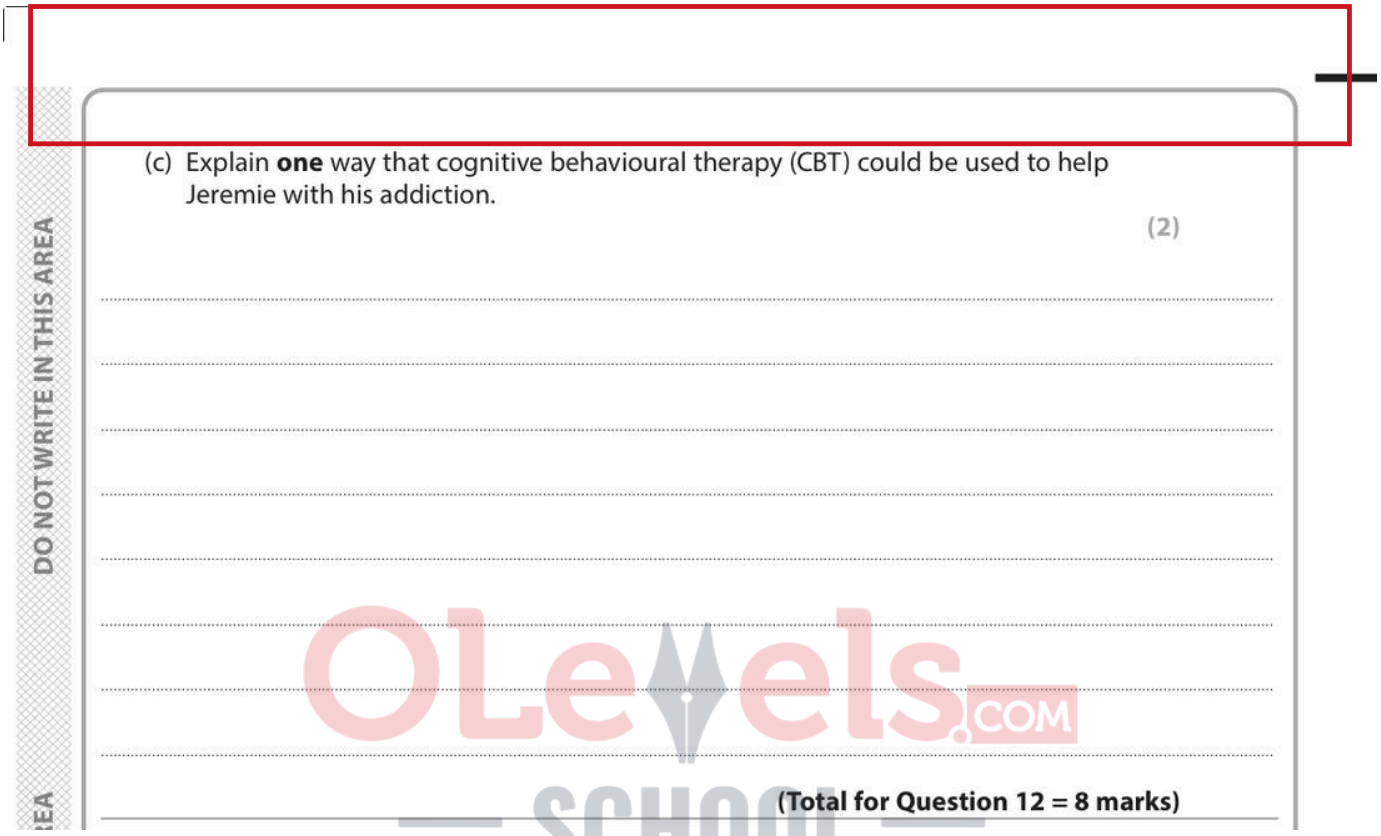
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# 1. Question 12 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.



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(c) Explain **one** way that cognitive behavioural therapy (CBT) could be used to help Jeremie with his addiction.

**(2)**

**(Total for Question 12 = 8 marks)**

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Working and answer

## 2. Question 14 · part a · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

**14** Aliyah's family all have mobile phones. Her mother and father frequently use their mobile phones when Aliyah is in the room. Aliyah's older sister never seems to put her mobile phone down.

Aliyah was recently given a mobile phone for her 12th birthday and gets very anxious and upset when she cannot find it. She is always checking her Instagram and cannot think clearly if her mobile phone is not in direct sight at all times.

Aliyah has been losing sleep to continue checking her Twitter page throughout the night and feels happy whenever she receives a message from her followers.

Aliyah has recently been diagnosed with addiction.

(a) Explain how learning theory could account for Aliyah's addiction.

**(2)**

(b) Aliyah has been asked to attend cognitive behaviour therapy (CBT) in an attempt to treat her addiction.

Explain how effective CBT is likely to be for Aliyah's addiction.

You should refer to Young (2007) in your answer.

**(2)**

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## 2. Question 14 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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